

July 15, 2026

Hiring Team
GoDaddy
Re: Director, Applied ML/AI

GoDaddy's challenge is not whether generative AI can create a logo, a page, a campaign, or a recommendation. It is whether those capabilities can become a coherent, globally scalable personalization system that helps an entrepreneur make the next useful move while preserving customer control, operating reliability, and measurable business value.

That is the mandate I would pursue. My candidate thesis is simple: **resolve the next best move, then prove it created momentum**. The operating mechanism behind that thesis makes five things explicit for every personalized action: the customer's current state, the next useful move, the agent's authority, the evidence required to continue, and the point at which the answer must be refreshed.

My background is unconventional for this role, and I will not blur that fact. I do not present a conventional eight-plus-year ML engineering leadership ladder or a verified global recommendation-system portfolio. I bring adjacent depth in the operating systems around models: leading engineering and high-reliability technical organizations; running customer-backward operations at Amazon scale; connecting telemetry, quality, customer, support, and engineering signals across approximately 1,000 fielded robots at Vape-Jet; and directly designing agentic workflows that combine context, retrieval, human judgment, escalation, evaluation, governance, and adoption.

That experience prepared me to make technical capability legible to product, engineering, analytics, customer care, security, privacy, finance, and executive stakeholders - and to install the decision rights, evidence standards, team cadence, and operating controls that turn experiments into durable customer outcomes. It also taught me when to recruit, partner with, and defer to deeper specialists rather than manufacture expertise.

The independent candidate vision at <https://russelldudek.github.io/godaddy/> makes this reasoning tangible through an interactive Entrepreneur Outcome Resolver, a balanced outcome scorecard, a candid hard-objection analysis, and a first-120-days plan. It is not a claim about GoDaddy's undisclosed systems; it is a concrete hypothesis for how I would begin discovery.

I would welcome a rigorous conversation about where GoDaddy most needs personalization to change an entrepreneur outcome, where agent authority is currently ambiguous, and what evidence would earn greater investment in the three-year roadmap.

Carpe diem,
Russell Dudek